

Latin Roots ten / tain

I can use ten / tain to understand words about holding and keeping.

Today I am learning to:

- ☐ understand the root
- ☐ build root-family words
- ☐ match words to meanings
- ☐ use words in context

1 Discover the Meaning

The Latin roots ten / tain mean hold.
Look for what is held, kept inside or kept in good condition.



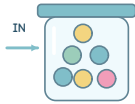
tenant

a person who rents a home or other property



tenacious

holding firmly and not letting go



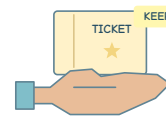
contain

to hold something inside



container

an object used to hold or store things



retain

to keep or continue to hold something



maintain

to keep something in good condition

2 Complete the Words

Write ten or tain to complete each word.

- _____ ant (a person who rents)
- _____ acious (holding on firmly)
- con _____ (hold inside)
- con _____ er (a storage object)
- re _____ (keep something)
- main _____ (keep in good condition)

3 Choose the Meaning

Tick the best meaning for each word.

- | | | |
|---------------------|--|---|
| 1. tenant | ☐ a person who rents a home | ☐ a person who builds houses |
| 2. tenacious | ☐ letting go easily | ☐ holding on firmly |
| 3. contain | ☐ hold something inside | ☐ spill something out |
| 4. container | ☐ a person who rents a home | ☐ an object for storing things |
| 5. retain | ☐ give something away | ☐ keep something |
| 6. maintain | ☐ keep in good condition | ☐ let something fall apart |

4 Match the Word to the Picture

Draw a line from each word to its picture.

tenant

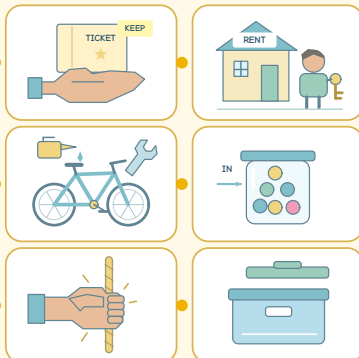
tenacious

contain

container

retain

maintain



5 Use the Words

Use each word once to finish the sentences.

tenant	tenacious	contain
container	retain	maintain

- The _____ pays rent for the flat.
- This jar can _____ six marbles.
- Keep your lunch in a _____.
- Please _____ your ticket until we arrive.
- Oil helps us _____ the bicycle.
- She held the rope with a _____ grip.

6 Challenge!



Choose one word. Explain how hold helps you understand it. Then draw a matching picture.

Draw your picture.



You did it!

I can use word parts to unlock meanings.

ten / tain
hold